The Quiet *Interface*

On attention, margins, and tools that step back.

A reader should feel like a room, not a control panel.

2026

One

A good reading tool is mostly absence. It gives a document a generous surface, keeps the controls within reach, and then stops asking for attention. The margin is not empty space. It is room for the eye to rest.

We built Folio around a small set of promises: the page should arrive quickly, the interface should not compete with the text, and a note should land exactly where it was drawn. Everything else is in service of those promises.

The luminous margin is where reading becomes thinking. A highlight is a decision to return. A note is a thought held in place. A signature is a deliberate act, never an automatic one.

Large documents test the honesty of a reader. A three-hundred-page report cannot be rendered all at once; search cannot block the page; annotations cannot drift under rotation. These are not edge cases. They are the work.

Local-first is a posture, not a feature list. The document stays where it is. The library is a convenience, not a copy in someone else's account. When the network disappears, the reading room remains.

Night reading should quiet the page without turning the whole interface into a cave. The page is treated; the controls remain recognizable. The two preferences are allowed to disagree.

Search results arrive from the text layer in the background. Type while the index is still filling. The count settles when the document is ready, and the current match never jumps to a different page behind your back.

A visual signature is a picture, not a certificate. Folio says so plainly, asks for approval, and embeds the image as a transparent stamp. The product should never borrow trust it has not earned.

Acknowledgment

By signing below, the reader agrees to keep the margin luminous.

Signature

Date

Sign here

Folio will still ask you to approve placement before adding anything.